Mandayam Family Steps In

At this point, another vital investor, the Mandayam family, stepped in (Figure 17). Hailing from Mandya in Mysore State, the Mandayam family were descendants of the twelfth-century Vaishnava preceptor Ramanuja's followers who had escaped the persecution of the Chola king.[18] In modern times, the family boasted of many stalwarts. Though they were social conservatives, they contributed significantly to the politically radical strand of the Indian nationalist movement. Mandayam Alasinga Perumal (1865–1909), apart from being a major contributor of funds for Vivekananda's trip to the Chicago World Parliament of Religions (1893), also edited the Ramakrishna Mission's monthly *Brahmavadin*. M.O. Parthasarathy Iyengar (1886–1963) was a distinguished botanist. M.P.T. Acharya (1887–1954), involved in the plot to assassinate Sir Curzon-Wyllie, was a founding member of the Communist Party of India (at Tashkent, in 1920) and an internationally renowned anarcho-syndicalist.[19] The cousins S.N. Thirumalachari and S. Srinivasachari were the proprietors of *India*, the weekly that was the primary forum for Subramania Bharati. The Mandayam brothers (S. Thirumalachari, S. Srinivasachari, S. Parthasarathy) and their cousin (father's younger brother's son) S.N. Thirumalachari, individually and jointly invested in SSNCo, even as it was hurtling towards bankruptcy.

The Mandayam brothers did not stop at investing in the company. The youngest, S. Parthasarathy (1880–1929), a graduate and lawyer by training, as mentioned earlier, had gone around even in 1908 to raise funds for V.O. Chidambaram Pillai's defence.[20] Meeting Aurobindo in Calcutta, he had drawn his attention to the advantages of moving to French-ruled Pondicherry to escape the British Indian police.